10.4.1 Controlling access to the configuration of an RDS database

Access to the RDS service is controlled using the IAM service. IAM is responsible for controlling access to actions like creating, updating, and deleting an RDS database instance. IAM doesn't manage access inside the database; that's the job of the database engine. IAM policies define which configuration and management actions an identity is allowed to execute on RDS. You attach these policies to IAM users, groups, or roles to control what actions they can perform on the database.

The following listing shows an IAM policy that allows access to all RDS configuration and management actions. You could use this policy to limit access by attaching it only to trusted IAM users and groups.

Listing 10.4 Allowing access to all RDS service configuration and management actions

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [{
    "Effect": "Allow",     ①
    "Action": "rds:*",     ②
    "Resource": "*"        ③
  }]
}
```

① Allows the specified actions on the specified resources

② All possible actions on RDS service are specified (e.g., changes to the database configuration).

③ All RDS databases are specified.